

ACT TWO

Daddy's little girls have all grown up. **Shraddha Kapoor**, 20, daughter of on-screen villain Shakti Kapoor makes her debut with Leena Yadav's *Teen Patti* that stars Amitabh Bachchan.



The other is **Soniya Mehra**, daughter of the late actor Vinod Mehra, who debuted over two years ago with the dud *Victoria No. 203*. She's making a fresh start with *Basra*, in which Abhay Deol is her co-star.



ROLE CALL

After a gap of two years, **Shabana Azmi** is returning to the stage with a lead role in *Broken Images*. Directed by Alyque Padamsee and based on a play by Girish Karnad, it centres round Manjula Nayak, an average Hindi writer who finds success in writing an English bestseller. Azmi will enact two sides of the same person confronted by her conscience. "She was the one actor who could carry off this solo act," says Padamsee. The play uses Azmi's electronic image to portray her other self. Two good, eh?

Hollywood Niche

First there was Jimi Mistry as a scientist in 2012. Now another American actor of Indian origin is playing a scientist, yet again. In James Cameron's mega-sized *Avatar*, **Dileep Rao** plays Dr Max Patel who helps the film's protagonist in the fight to protect the Na'vis from Pandora. We know that an Indian won a Nobel prize in chemistry this year, but someone should tell Hollywood that an Indian is not always equal to a doctor.



SONIYA (LEFT) AND SHRADDHA



Feud for Thought

Here's another man banking on the MNS-Shiv Sena saga. Marathi composer **Avadhoot Gupte**, famous for *Aika Dajeeba*, has directed a film on the feud between the two parties. Gupte has worked with both Uddhav and Raj Thackeray and says he understands the sentiments of both the leaders and their followers. "The film *Zenda* (flag) portrays selfishness, cruelty, corruption and the yet pure-hearted nature of the *karyakartas*," he adds. Wonder if the feuding cousins have given this a dekho?

